R **Rippling Removal for Windows**

Version 1.3.1 · Dry-run by default

POST-MIGRATION CLEANUP UTILITY

Removing Rippling management components from Windows devices

A safety-first cleanup script that reports before it removes. This overview explains what the utility inspects, what it removes, and the controls that keep it predictable on every device it runs on.

PLATFORM

Windows · runs as SYSTEM via management console

DOCUMENT

Operational Overview

01

What this utility does

After a Windows device has been migrated to its new management platform, some Rippling-related components can remain installed, running, or on disk. This utility performs a structured sweep to identify and remove those leftover components, and it reports everything it finds in a clear, readable log.

The script is designed to be pushed from your management console as a custom script and runs with SYSTEM privileges. It works in three phases on every run: a read-only assessment of the device's current state, a leftover sweep that either reports or removes depending on the mode you select, and a closing summary with a verdict.

02

Two modes, one setting

A single setting controls the entire behavior of the script. It ships in the safe mode, so the first time it touches any device it only looks and reports.

`$DryRun = $true` DEFAULT

Scans the device and reports only. Nothing is changed, deleted, or stopped. Use this to review exactly what would be removed before committing to any action.

`$DryRun = $false` LIVE

Runs the same scan and then removes the items it finds. The removal steps are repeatable, so the script can be safely run again on any device without adverse effect.

i Suggested workflow
Push the script as-is to one device, review the summary and the list of items it found, and only then switch to live mode and re-push. The summary is written to be read at a glance.

03

Built-in safety controls

- ✓ Report-only mode is the shipped default
- ✓ Every item is logged as found before anything is removed
- ✓ When an item cannot be removed, it is named in the log and counted in the summary
- ✓ Removal of the local administrator account is a separate, off-by-default option
- ✓ Removal of the software-delivery service (Chocolatey) is a separate, off-by-default option
- ✓ Items that are absent are skipped silently, without errors
- ✓ Removal follows a deliberate order, so no component can restore another mid-cleanup
- ✓ A summary and result verdict close every run

04

How a run is structured

Each run moves through three phases. The first only observes; the second does the work; the third reports the outcome.

PHASE 1 · READ-ONLY

Migration state assessment

- Checks whether the new management agent is present on the device
- Checks for any remaining Rippling MDM enrollment records — inspection only, never modified
- Reports whether the Rippling application is still installed, and notes when a live run (rather than a restart) is what the device needs
- Detects whether the device has a restart pending — including files Windows has queued for deletion at the next restart

PHASE 2 · SWEEP

Leftover removal, in a deliberate order

- Removes Rippling scheduled tasks first — including Rippling's watchdog/repair task, so nothing can restore components mid-cleanup
- Stops and deletes the Rippling agent service
- Stops any Rippling processes still running
- Runs the official Rippling uninstaller silently, if it is still present
- Removes Rippling autostart entries, machine-wide and for every user profile
- Removes Rippling folders: the program directory, system data, and per-user application data
- Removes Rippling entries from the Windows uninstall records — scoped to those records only
- Optionally removes the software-delivery service and the local administrator account — each governed by its own off-by-default setting

PHASE 3 · REPORT

Summary and verdict

- Counts of items found, removed, and — if any — not removed
- Whether a restart is pending on the device
- A single plain-language result line summarizing the run
- Output is written both to the management console and to a timestamped log file kept on the device
- The script's exit code reflects the outcome: success, or attention needed

ℹ A note on pending restarts

Windows queues files that are in use for deletion at the next restart, and the assessment phase reports when such a restart is pending. When the Rippling application is still installed, a live run is required — a restart alone will not remove it. After a successful live run, a restart simply completes the queued file deletions.

05

Scope and boundaries

What the sweep removes

✓ Rippling scheduled tasks, including the watchdog/repair task

✓ The Rippling agent service

✓ Running Rippling processes

✓ The Rippling application, via its own official uninstaller

✓ Autostart entries (machine-wide and per-user)

✓ Rippling folders and per-user application data

✓ Rippling entries in the Windows uninstall records

What it does not touch

— MDM enrollment records — inspected read-only and left to the migration process; the new platform's own enrollment lives alongside them

— Endpoint security (EDR) software, even where it was delivered through Rippling

— The software-delivery service (Chocolatey), unless that option is explicitly enabled

— The local administrator account, unless that option is explicitly enabled

— Any component that is not present on the device

! The two options to review before enabling

Local administrator account — off by default. Rippling creates a local administrator account on Windows devices; on some fleets it may be the only local administrator. Confirm another local administrator exists before enabling this option.

Software-delivery service — off by default. Rippling uses Chocolatey to deliver applications on Windows. Removing it does not uninstall the applications it installed — they simply stop being managed by it. Confirm nothing else on the device depends on it before enabling.

✓ Safe to run more than once

The removal steps are repeatable. If a run reports that an item could not be removed, the script can be run again after a restart. Nothing already removed is affected by a second run.

06

Reading the result

Every run ends with one of the following result lines, so the outcome is clear without reading the full log.

RESULT	WHAT IT MEANS
CLEAN	No Rippling components were found on the device. Nothing needed to be done.
DRY RUN complete	Items were found and listed, but the script was in report-only mode and made no changes.
CLEANED	Items were found and successfully removed in live mode. A restart is recommended to flush any file deletions Windows has queued.
PARTIAL	One or more items could not be removed — typically files held in use. They are named in the log; a re-run after a restart is recommended.